

FEATURE • NARRATIVE BUILD

# Assemble the slide as you go.

A dense slide lands all at once. Walked live, the story is better told one beat at a time — a bullet, a table row, a line of code. `_build` makes that a one-line directive, derived from the slide's own structure, and it degrades to the whole slide in print.

# The slide is the same. The reveal is the argument.

You don't split the content across slides — you sequence it in place. One grammar, a subset of `_focus`, addresses any surface: `item`, `row`, `col`, `line`. Document order is the order it builds.

## `_build` — one step per point, in order.

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- First you frame the problem.
- Then you show the evidence.
- Then you draw the conclusion.
- And only then the ask.

## `_build: 1, 2-3, 4` — group beats into steps.

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- The setup stands alone.
- These two land together —
- — because they're one idea in two halves.
- The payoff arrives last.

`_build: rows` — reveal the comparison row by row.

| CRITERION    | OPTION A                                                                          | OPTION B                                                                            | OPTION C                                                                            |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Speed        |  |  |  |
| Auditability |  |  |  |
| Cost         | Low                                                                               | High                                                                                | Low                                                                                 |

## `_build: lines` — walk the code a line at a time.

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```
function reveal(step) {  
  const units = section.querySelectorAll('[data-build-step]');  
  for (const u of units) u.classList.toggle('lat-built', +u.dataset.buildStep <= step);  
}
```

# Derived, restrained, print-faithful.

*Beamer overlays, not PowerPoint.*

*The engine only tags the steppable units; the reveal is pure CSS. With no player driving it — and in every PDF — the slide simply shows whole. The live walk-through is the enhancement, never the artifact.*